

QUEEN OF ENGLAND Born 1533 Died 1603

Elizabeth I

“I have the body but of a
weak and feeble woman,
but... the **heart... of**
a king” ELIZABETH I AT TILBURY, 1588

From her earliest years, England's future Queen Elizabeth I was surrounded by danger and intrigue. Her birth was a disappointment to her father, Henry VIII, who was desperate for a male heir. He had declared himself head of the English Church so he could divorce and marry again, in an effort to produce a son with his new wife. Elizabeth was two-and-a-half when her mother, Henry's second wife Anne Boleyn, was executed on his orders, accused of adultery. Declared illegitimate, Elizabeth was relegated to court life, finding safety in discretion. After Henry's death in 1547 she was taken under the protection of his widow and sixth wife, Catherine Parr, and educated together with her half-brother, the future Edward VI.

Her elder half-sister Mary's accession to the throne in 1553 placed Elizabeth in a perilous situation. The Catholic Mary

Gloriana
Elizabeth I's style of dress expressed both her love of finery and her desire to present an image of power and magnificence.



The Tudor Rose

The symbol of the Tudor dynasty, of which Elizabeth was the fourth monarch, was created by Henry VII.

Henry VIII

Elizabeth I's father was a true Renaissance man. He was highly educated, fluent in several languages, and adept at sports such as tennis. He was also an avid huntsman. One of Henry's lasting legacies is the establishment of the Church of England.

